

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1206

By Terry

A RESOLUTION to honor Rick Insell on the occasion of his retirement as the women's basketball coach at Middle Tennessee State University.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in paying tribute to a legendary coach, skilled tactician, and inspirational motivator who has experienced great success during his forty-nine years in high school and college basketball; and

WHEREAS, Rick Insell, head coach of the Middle Tennessee State University (MTSU) women's basketball team for the past twenty-one years, has announced that he will take his much-deserved retirement at the conclusion of the 2025-2026 season, thus ending the most successful era in the history of the program; and

WHEREAS, Coach Insell is the winningest basketball coach in MTSU history with 505 wins, having won at least 20 games in eighteen of his twenty-one seasons and at least 25 wins in nine seasons; and

WHEREAS, Coach Insell has led his alma mater to twenty conference championships, (ten regular season titles and ten conference tournament titles) and thirteen conference championship games; and

WHEREAS, his Lady Raiders teams have made twenty-one consecutive postseason appearances, including twelve NCAA Tournament bids and seven WNIT bids; and

WHEREAS, sixty-six players on teams led by Coach Insell have earned All-Conference honors, seven have been named All-Americans, and five have been selected in the Women's National Basketball Association draft; and

WHEREAS, he is the only basketball coach in NCAA history to produce three consecutive NCAA scoring champions and the only coach in history to win more than 500 games at both the NCAA Division I level and in high school; and

WHEREAS, a legend in his profession, Coach Insell has received five Conference Coach of the Year awards in recognition of his prowess, and he is a nine-time Hall of Fame inductee, including the Women's Basketball Hall of Fame, Tennessee Sports Hall of Fame, and Conference USA Hall of Fame; and

WHEREAS, Coach Insell has posted 1,279 wins in his peerless career, a total that includes 775 wins over twenty-eight seasons as the girls' basketball coach at Shelbyville Central High School; and

WHEREAS, he won ten TSSAA Class AAA state championships and two *USA Today* national titles at Shelbyville Central and earned four national coach of the year honors; and

WHEREAS, Coach Insell's high school coaching accomplishments also include a national-record 110-game winning streak during which the Golden Eaglettes won four consecutive state titles (1989-1992); and

WHEREAS, Coach Insell's passion for the game, his commitment to graduating his student athletes, and his leadership in creating a championship culture have defined MTSU women's basketball for more than two decades; and

WHEREAS, he has positively influenced many lives during his tenure at MTSU, and he will forever be part of the school's athletic community; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor Rick Insell, the winningest coach in Middle Tennessee State University basketball history, on the occasion of his retirement as the school's women's basketball coach, salute his forty-nine years of excellence in the sport, and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.